Ashwin Kambhampati

CONTACT

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Last Update: October 2026
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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor of Economics, United States Naval Academy — 2021-Present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Pennsylvania — 2021
A.M. in Economics, University of Pennsylvania — 2018
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics, Oberlin College — 2014

INTERESTS

Microeconomic Theory (Mechanism Design, Contract Theory, Matching), Industrial Organization

WORKING PAPERS

"Lexicographic Robustness and the Efficiency of Optimal Mechanisms"
Second revision submitted to the *American Economic Review*.

"Randomization and the Robustness of Linear Contracts"
(with B. Peng, Z. Tang, J. Toikka, and R. Vohra)

PUBLICATIONS

"Robust Performance Evaluation of Independent Agents"
Theoretical Economics, July 2024, Vol. 19.
Abstract published in *EC'22*.

"Randomization is Optimal in the Robust Principal-Agent Problem"
Journal of Economic Theory, January 2023, Vol. 207.

"The Optimal Assortativity of Teams Inside the Firm"
(with C. Segura-Rodriguez)
RAND Journal of Economics, Fall 2022, Vol. 53: 484-515.

"Payoff Continuity in Games of Incomplete Information Across Models of Knowledge"
Games and Economic Behavior, February 2026, Vol. 156.

"Why Informationally Diverse Teams Need Not Form, Even When Efficient"
(with C. Segura-Rodriguez and P. Shao)
Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, October 2024, Vol. 226.

"Pay Equality Among Heterogeneous Agents"
(with R. Hoffman and S. Kaplan)
Economics Letters, August 2023, Vol. 229.
Ryan's 2023 honors thesis, co-supervised with S. Kaplan.

INVITED SEMINARS

2026: University of Chicago

2025: Yale University, New York University, Cornell University, Northwestern University

2024: University of Pennsylvania, Columbia University, Rutgers University

2023: Arizona State University, Johns Hopkins University

2021: Johns Hopkins University (Carey School of Business), Not the 2021 Theory Job Market Seminar (Warwick), United States Department of Justice, United States Naval Academy

Conferences

2026: ASSA Annual Meeting, NBER Decentralization Conference, Kansas Workshop in Economic Theory

2025: Canadian Economic Theory Conference, SAET Conference

2024: Lisbon Meetings in Game Theory, Southern Economic Association

2023: Canadian Economic Theory Conference, North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, Southern Economic Association, Midwest Economic Theory Conference

2022: Johns Hopkins University (guest lecturer in J. Quah's second-year Ph.D. course), Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics, Southern Economic Association

2021: European Economic Association Meeting/ Econometric Society European Meeting, 6th World Congress of the Game Theory Society, 22nd ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC'21), North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society

Before 2021: 12th World Congress of the Econometric Society, 29th Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory

Service

Refereeing

American Economic Review (x1), *Econometrica* (x3), *Quarterly Journal of Economics* (x1), *Review of Economic Studies* (x2), *American Economic Review: Insights* (x1), *International Economic Review* (x3), *Theoretical Economics* (x5), *Journal of Economic Theory* (x1), *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics* (x1), *The RAND Journal of Economics* (x1), *Games and Economic Behavior* (x8), *Economic Theory* (x3), *Journal of Mathematical Economics* (x1), *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy* (x1)

Program committees

27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC'26)

Departmental service

Swarthmore Honors Examiner for ECON 162: Antitrust & Market Regulation	2025
Internal Consultant for USNA Division of Professional Development	2022-2025
Economics Department Awards Committee	2022-2025
Co-Founder of USNA Economics Speaker Series (with S. Kaplan)	2022-2023

Teaching

United States Naval Academy

SM275, Mathematical Methods for Economics (2 sections)	2024
FE461, Industrial Organization (8 sections)	2022, 2023, 2026
SE450, Game Theory (19 sections)	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
SE475, Capstone Undergraduate Research Seminar (4 sections)	2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

University of Pennsylvania

ECON101, Intermediate Microeconomics (1 section)	2017

Advising

Letter Writer for USMA Cadet Shepherd Dzina 2024

Rhodes Scholarship Winner 2025

Honors Advisor to USNA Midshipman R. Hoffman (with S. Kaplan) 2022-2023

Naval Intelligence Foundation Award for Best Yardwide Honors Thesis

Clair Morris Prize for Best Economics Honors Thesis

Independent Study Advisor to USNA Midshipman A. Larson 2022

Roger Little Omicron Delta Epsilon Award for Most Outstanding Graduate
Honors Advisor to USNA Midshipman P. Yamasaki (with N. Utgoff) 2021-2022
Clair Morris Prize for Best Economics Honors Thesis
FQE Academic Advisor to 18 Midshipmen in Class of 2025 2022-2025
FQE Academic Advisor to 6 Midshipmen in Class of 2027 2025-present
FQE Academic Advisor to 9 Midshipmen in Class of 2029 2026-present

Awards

United States Naval Academy
- Econ Nominee Class of 1951 Faculty Research Excellence Award (campus-wide award) 2026
- Econ Nominee Apgar Teaching Excellence Award (campus-wide award) 2025
- Volgenau Faculty Fellowship 2021-2024, 2024-2027
- Junior Naval Academy Research Council Grant 2022-2024

University of Pennsylvania
- Joel Popkin Graduate Student Teaching Prize in Economics 2018
- CTL Teaching Certificate 2017
- University Fellowship 2014-2020

Oberlin College
- Phi Beta Kappa 2014
- High Honors in Economics 2014
- Omicron Delta Epsilon 2014
- Comfort Starr Prize in Economics (excellence in college work) 2014
- Jesse Phillips Prize in Economics (most outstanding junior) 2013

Other

White House Council of Economic Advisers, Intern 2013
United States Department of Justice, Antitrust Division, Intern 2012